

User Story

A user story describes something that the user wants to accomplish by using the software product.

As a **[persona]**,

Who

The persona is a vivid, humanised, yet operational description of a user.

I want to **[do something]**,

What

This is a some action you assume the user wants to do.

so that I can **[derive a benefit]**

Why

This is benefit / motivation / reason why the user wants to perform the action.

not HOW?

Requirements in Agile / Scrum may not follow “user story” format but it should cover information of **WHO-WHAT-WHY**.

User Story

As a customer,
I want to be able to cancel my reservation,
so that I do not lose all the money if an incident occurs.

Acceptance Criteria

- Verify that a premium member can cancel the same day without a fee.
- Verify that a non-premium member is charged 10% for a same-day cancellation.
- Verify that an email confirmation is sent.
- Verify that the hotel is notified of any cancellation.

Card

3C

Describe the user story in short form to allow common understanding of the user need

Conversation

User stories shift the focus from writing about features **to discussing them**. In fact, these discussions are more important than whatever text is written.

Confirmation

Confirm the understanding is correct.
Confirm the story is ready for next step of development.

User Story Splitting / Agile Requirements Decomposition

Technique 1 Workflow

Examine the workflow of a process, and create stories for steps in that workflow.

Before

As a grocery store cashier, I want to checkout a customer, so that I can complete the sales transaction.

After

As a grocery store cashier, I want to...

- ...calculate the total amount that will be charged to customer
- ...specify the method of payment preferred by the customer
- ...enter the credit card details
- ...print a receipt for the customer

Technique 2 Data Details

For complex data or user interfaces, write stories for related elements

Before

As a student, I want to view my grades for this semester's courses, so that I can see how I'm performing.

After

As a student, I want to view...

- ...my numeric grade for this semester's courses, so that I can quantify my performance.
- ...my letter grade for this semester's courses, so that I can calculate my GPA easily
- ...the class average for this semester's courses, so that I understand my relative performance.

Technique 3 Happy Path

For complex workflows, create a story to complete the happy path, i.e., the case where everything goes perfectly, and then create stories which deal with the deviations from the happy path (i.e., alternative flows).

Before

As a UBER-taxi customer, I want to view information about my booked taxi, so that I can track its movement.

After

As a UBER-taxi customer, I want to view information about...

- ...an on-time taxi, so that I can track its movement
- ...a delayed taxi, so that I can track its movement
- ...a cancelled taxi, so that I can re-book another one..

Technique 4 Core+Enhance

Do the core, then enhance: Create a story for the difficult part of the work where key learnings will happen; then create stories which complete the work

Before

As a Salesforce user, I want to create revenue, profit, and growth reports, so that I can perform monthly forecasting.

After

As a Salesforce user, I want to...

- ...to create a revenue report for a month, so that I can view the revenue generated in that month
- ...to create revenue, profit, and growth reports for all months, so that I can perform forecasting for the next month.

Technique 5 Business Rules

Many user stories involve a number of **explicit or implicit** business rules. Break each rule in a user story.

Before

As a customer, I want to purchase the goods in my shopping basket so that I can receive my products at home.

After

As a shop owner, I want to...

- ...decline orders below 10 dollars, because I don't make any profit on them;
- ...decline customers from outside the US, because the shipping expenses make these orders unprofitable;
- ...reserve ordered products from stock for 48 hours, so other customers see a realistic stock;
- ...automatically cancel orders for which I have not received payment within 48 hours, so I can sell them again to other customers;

Technique 6 Operation

Stories often involves a number of default operations, e.g., CRUD. These operations are very prevalent when functionality involves the management of entities.

Before

As shop owner I want to manage products in my online shop, so I can update price and product information if it is changed.

After

As a shop owner, I want to...

- ...add new products, so customers can purchase them;
- ...update existing products, so I can adjust for changes in pricing or product information;
- ...delete products, so I can remove products that I no longer stock;
- ...hide products, so they cannot be sold for the time being;